

PEACE BY PAGE



# *Calm Nights*

SOS Calm-Down Kit

11 pages for the hard moments



# *A few words first*

## About this toolkit

Calm Nights is a self-reflection toolkit for general wellbeing. It is not medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment, and it supports, not replaces, care from a licensed professional. If something in here doesn't feel right for you, skip it.

## If you need help now

|                       |                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>In the US</b>      | Call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or text HOME to 741741. Free and confidential, 24/7.  |
| <b>Emergency</b>      | Call 911, or your local emergency number, if you or someone else is in danger.                      |
| <b>Outside the US</b> | Find a free helpline in your country at <a href="https://findahelpline.com">findahelpline.com</a> . |

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## Printing

See the "How to print" guide that came with your download for paper, double-sided printing, and print-shop tips. Colored pencils work best on the coloring pages.

# *When anxiety hits, start here*

Go one step at a time. You can stop as soon as you feel a little steadier.

1

## *Breathe*

pages 4 and 5

Slow your breathing first. Try box breathing, or breathe in for 4 and out for 6. A longer out-breath helps your body settle.

2

## *Ground*

page 6

Come back to the room you're in. Name 5 things you see, 4 you can feel, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, and 1 you taste.

3

## *Color or move*

page 10

Give your hands and body something to do. Color a page, stretch, walk, or shake out your arms and legs.

4

## *Write*

pages 8 and 9

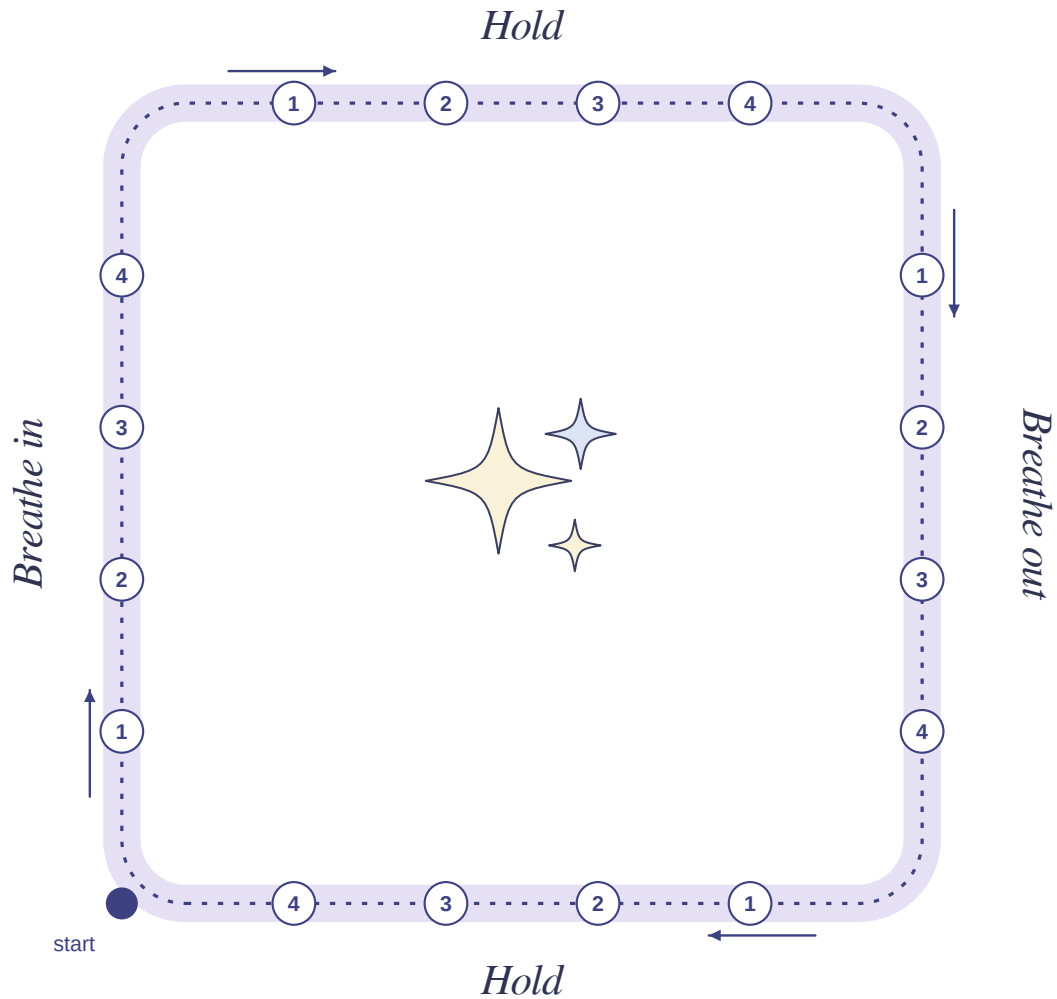
Once the wave settles a little, write it out. The thought record or the worry tree can help you untangle it.



**Feeling unsafe? Call or text 988, any time.**

# Box breathing

Trace the square with a finger or pen. Each side is four slow counts. Start at the dot and follow the arrows.

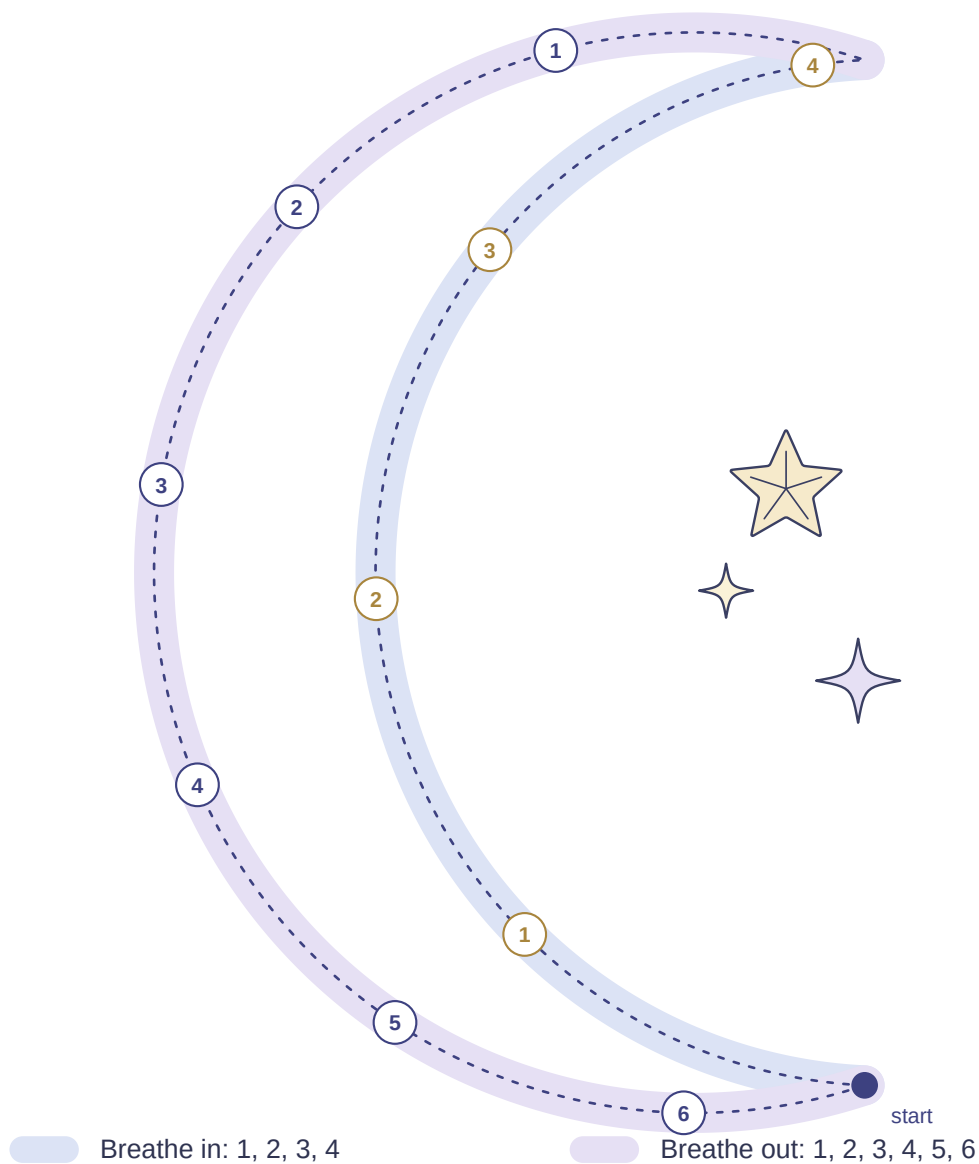


Go around four times, or for as long as it feels good. If holding your breath feels uncomfortable, skip the holds and breathe in and out slowly instead.

How I felt before \_\_\_\_\_ after \_\_\_\_\_ (0 to 10)

## Long-exhale breathing

A longer out-breath tells your body it's safe to slow down. Breathe in for 4, out for 6. Trace the moon from the dot: in as you travel up the inside curve, out as you glide around the outside edge and back to the start.



Go around the moon five times, or for as long as it feels good. If 4 and 6 feel too long, try 3 and 5. What matters is that the out-breath is longer than the in-breath.

## 5-4-3-2-1 grounding

When your mind is racing ahead, bring it back to right here. Go slowly and notice the small details: colors, textures, quiet sounds.

**5** *things I can see*

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**4** *things I can feel or touch*

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**3** *things I can hear*

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**2** *things I can smell*

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**1** *thing I can taste, or one slow breath*

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Now I feel

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# Progressive muscle relaxation

Tense each part of your body for about 5 seconds, then let it go for about 10 seconds and notice the difference. Tense gently. It should never hurt. Sitting or lying down both work.

**My favorite calming audio** a song, playlist, podcast, or guided recording that helps me relax

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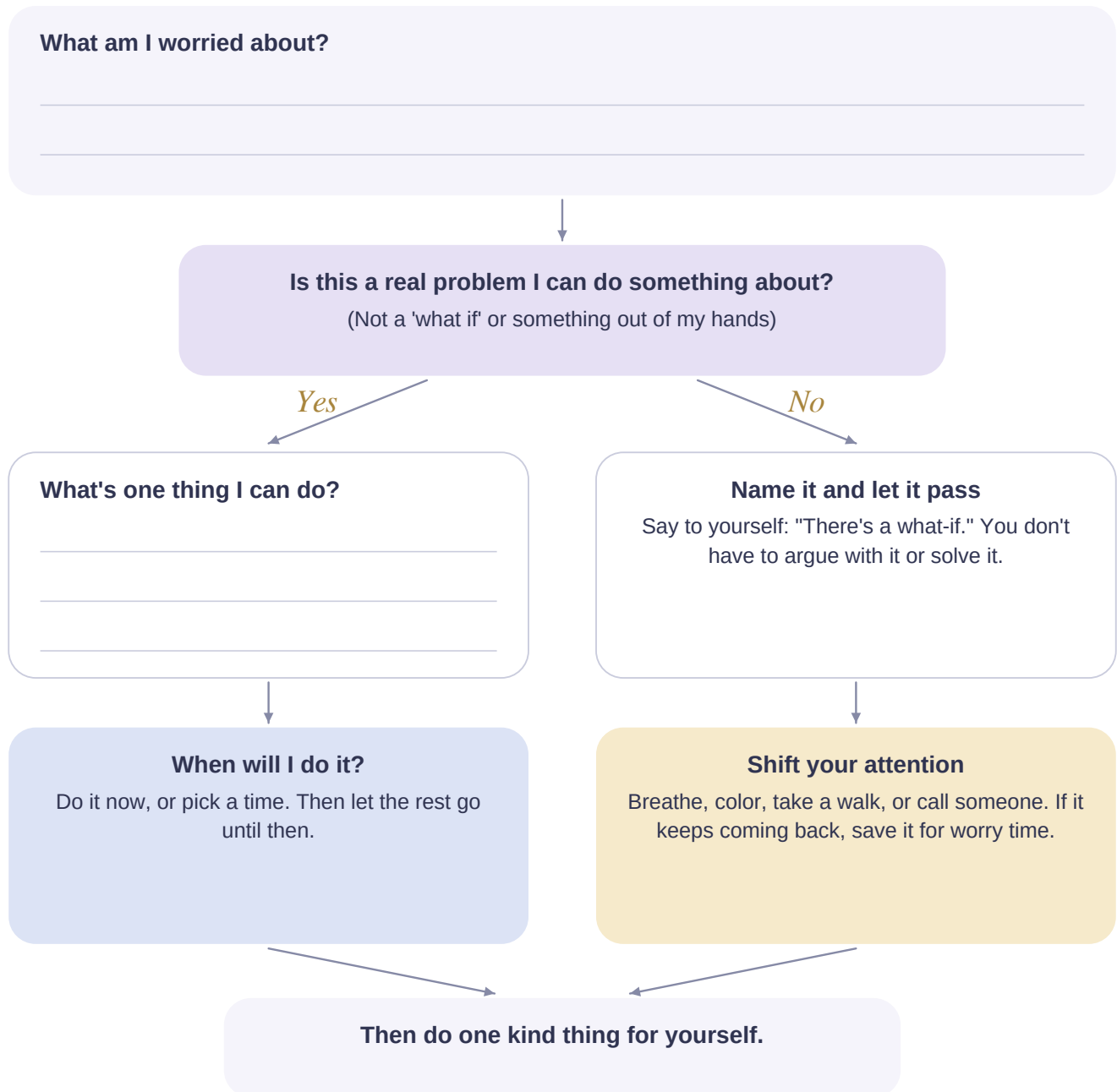
- 1 **Hands** Make tight fists. Hold, then let your fingers fall open.
- 2 **Arms** Bend your elbows and tighten your upper arms. Hold, then let them drop.
- 3 **Shoulders** Lift your shoulders up toward your ears. Hold, then let them sink down.
- 4 **Face** Scrunch your eyes and nose. Hold, then let your forehead and jaw go soft.
- 5 **Belly** Take a breath and tighten your stomach. Hold, then breathe out and let it go.
- 6 **Legs** Press your knees together and tighten your thighs. Hold, then relax.
- 7 **Feet** Curl your toes down. Hold, then let them spread and rest.
- 8 **Whole body** One big breath in, and a long, slow breath out. Let everything go heavy.

*Stay still for a minute when you're done. Notice where you feel warmer, heavier, or looser.*

How I felt before \_\_\_\_\_ after \_\_\_\_\_ (0 to 10)

# The worry tree

Worries feel urgent, but they're not all the same kind. This helps you sort them so you know what to do next.



# Quick thought record

Thoughts aren't facts. They're quick guesses your brain makes, often when you're tired or stressed. Writing one down helps you look at it from a little further away.

**What happened?** where, when, who

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**What went through my mind?**

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How much I believe it \_\_\_\_\_ /10

Feelings and body \_\_\_\_\_

**What supports the thought?**

**What doesn't fit it?**

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**A more balanced thought** what would I tell a friend?

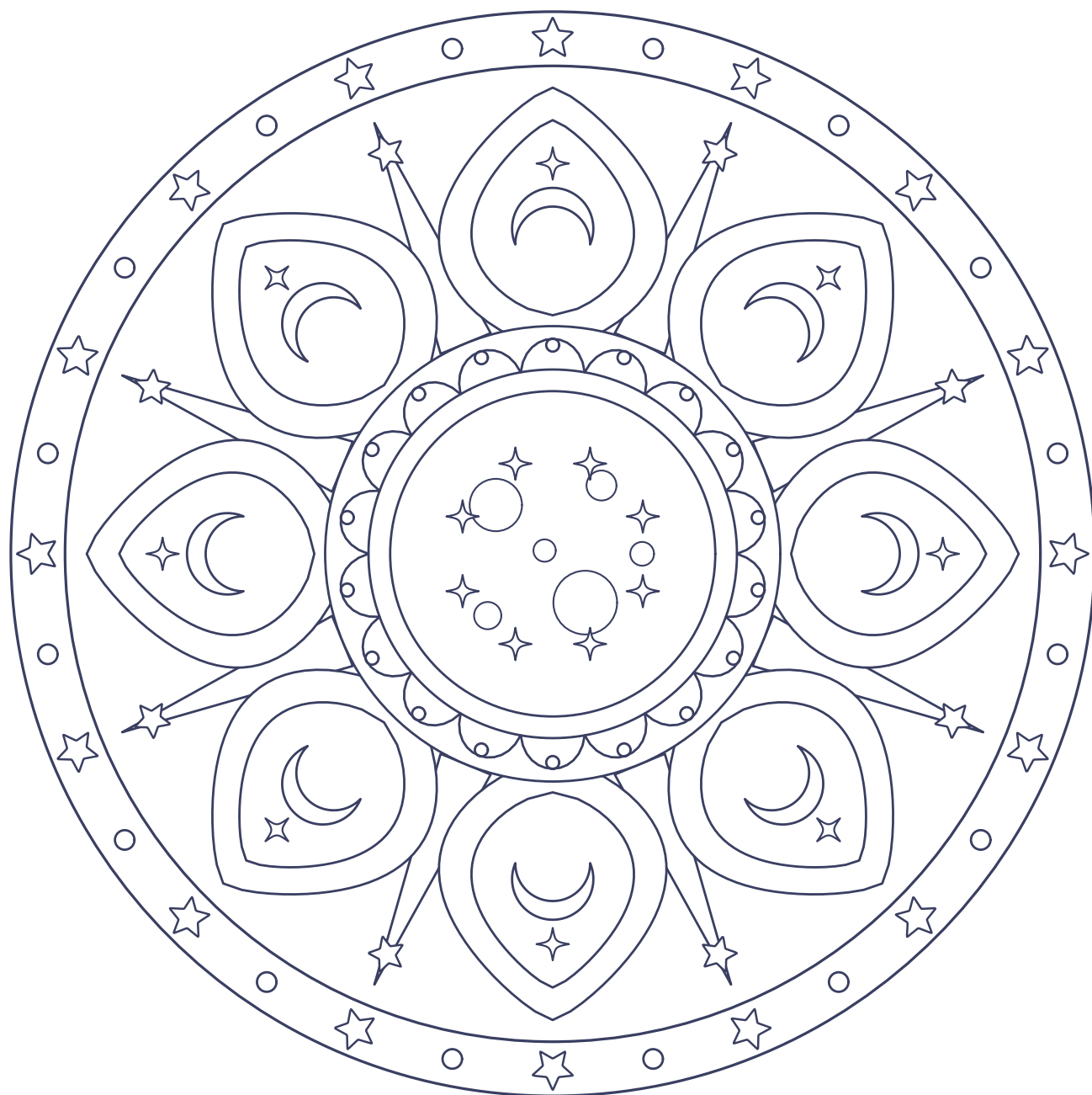
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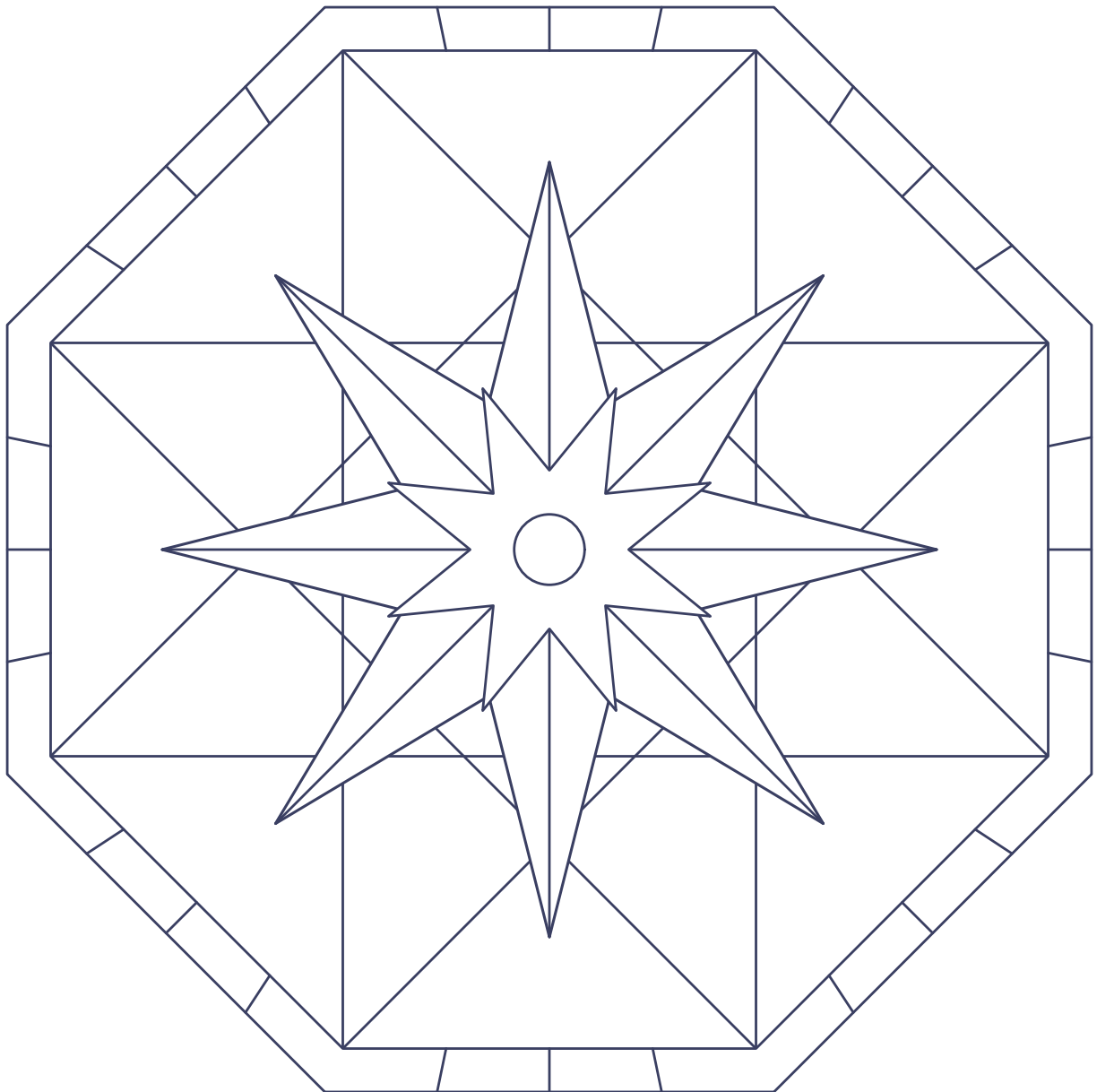
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How much I believe the balanced thought \_\_\_\_\_ /10

How I feel now \_\_\_\_\_



No rules. Any colors, any order, stop whenever you like.



No rules. Any colors, any order, stop whenever you like.



## *This will pass*



Gentle words for the hard moments. Read them slowly, out loud if you can. Circle the ones that fit.

*This is a wave. It will pass.*

*I've felt this before, and it eased.*

*My body is trying to protect me. Right now, I'm okay.*

*I don't have to fix everything this minute.*

*Breathe in. Breathe out slowly. Again.*

*I can feel anxious and still be safe.*

*This feeling is uncomfortable. It won't last forever.*

*I only need to take the next breath.*

*I can let this thought float by.*

*It's okay to pause.*

*I'm doing the best I can, and that's enough.*

**My own words**

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# When your mind won't switch off

Lying awake with a racing mind is common, and it passes. Go one step at a time, and stop whenever you feel a little calmer.

1

## *Keep it dim and calm*

Leave the lights low and the phone face down. Checking the time tends to wind a busy mind back up.

2

## *Set it down on paper*

Write the thoughts that keep looping on a notepad by your bed. They will still be there in the morning, so you don't have to hold on to them tonight.

3

## *Breathe long and slow*

Try long-exhale breathing (page 5) or the muscle relaxation on page 7. Let your body get heavy.

4

## *Rest without forcing it*

Lying quietly still rests your body. If you've been awake a long while and feel frustrated, get up, sit somewhere dim, and do something quiet until you feel sleepy. Then go back to bed.

### The thought I'm parking for tonight

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### What I'll tell myself if I wake up

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If trouble sleeping goes on for weeks, or worry keeps you up most nights, talk to a doctor. Feeling unsafe? Call or text 988, any time.

## *When to get more help*

This toolkit can help with everyday worry. Sometimes anxiety needs more support than a notebook can give, and that's okay. Think about talking to a doctor or therapist if:

- Worry or panic gets in the way of work, school, sleep, or relationships most days.
- You're avoiding more and more places, people, or things you used to enjoy.
- Panic attacks happen often, or you're scared of having the next one.
- You're leaning on alcohol, drugs, or other habits to get through the day.
- Your mood has been low for two weeks or more, or nothing feels enjoyable.
- It has been going on for a while and isn't easing, even with the tools in here.

### **Get help right away if**

- You have thoughts of hurting yourself or ending your life.
- You feel unsafe, or you're not sure you can keep yourself safe.

**988**

#### **Call or text 988**

US Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

Free, confidential, 24 hours a day. You can also chat at [988lifeline.org](https://988lifeline.org).

**If you or someone else is in immediate danger, call 911.**

*Asking for help is a strong, sensible thing to do. It is not a failure, and you don't have to wait until things are at their worst.*



## *Calm Nights*

This toolkit supports, not replaces, care from a professional.

In a crisis, call or text 988 (US). In an emergency, call 911.

Outside the US, call your local emergency number or visit [findahelpline.com](https://findahelpline.com).